

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, June 10, 2020, via Zoom.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Mayor Lovett read the following statement: *This meeting is being conducted in accordance with the provisions of the Governor's Executive Order no. 2020-04 and the emergency meeting provisions of RSA 91-A to permit participation of board members by electronic means. Under the conditions of the current COVID-19 pandemic and the protocols established by the Centers for Disease Control (CDC), it is not reasonably practical for a quorum of this board's members to attend this meeting in person. She read the telephone information to join the meeting and the phone number to call if having a problem.*

To join the webinar:

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/82983794724?pwd=ZVZGRm9HbFRhSTRUUWRYaUJSYUVodz09>
Password: 739587

Or Telephone:

Dial: 1 646 558 8656

Webinar ID: 829 8379 4724

Password: 739587

If there is a problem getting through to that number, please call 603-542-7002.

Members of the Council present were:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O'Hearne – Chambers – Councilors Sweetser & Stone

At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier – Home – Alone

At-Large Councilor Erica Sweetser – Chambers – Councilors O'Hearne & Stone

Assistant Mayor Allen Damren – Home – Alone

Mayor Charlene Lovett – Home – Alone

At-Large Councilor Debora Matteau – Home – Alone

At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski – Restaurant – Alone

Ward II Councilor James Contois – Home – Alone

Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone – Chambers – Councilors Sweetser & O'Hearne

Also present:

Edward Morris, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Lovett said the Approval/Denial of Police Union Contract will be moved to June 24th agenda as the Council wanted to see the contract before voting.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to accept the minutes of the May 13, 2020, City Council meeting as amended.

Mayor Lovett said on page 18, last paragraph, "...and he hasn't heard anything." Should be "...and he hasn't heard anything about naming something after the firefighter." On page 19, first sentence in paragraph before Consultation with Legal Counsel, should read "Mayor Lovett said Mr. O'Hearne's request to name City property after the firefighter that was lost, occurred about 1 ½ years ago."

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser – abstain, was not here

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0, 1 abstain.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Ms. Matteau to accept the minutes of the May 27, 2020, City Council meeting as amended.

Mayor Lovett said on page 1, the date should be May 27, 2020, not January 8, 2020. Under Mayor's Notes, second paragraph from bottom, should read "congratulations to RVCC and high school graduates of 2020."

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mayor Lovett talked about the murder of George Floyd. Several Councilors asked to speak about this. She wrote an article about preventing injustice that was published in the local papers. She thanked the participants of the peaceful protest on Monday.

Ms. Sweetser asked everyone to think about what they could do better tomorrow.

Ms. Kier agreed with Ms. Sweetser. She said although we don't have a problem of police brutality here, she would like a resolution condemning police brutality and supporting racial justice. Mayor Lovett said this can be discussed under Future Agenda Items.

Pride Weekend Proclamation

Mayor Lovett read a proclamation for Pride Weekend.

Maggie Monroe-Cassel, Executive Director of TLC (Teach Loving Connections) Family Resource Center, said that this would be the last time she would appear as the Executive Director of TLC. She will retire in four weeks and a new Executive Director will start July 13.

Matt Mooshian, Ward 2, said he appreciated the Pride recognition. This year marks 51 years since the Stonewall Uprising, which was a pivotal moment in LGBT history. Rural Outright has some awesome events planned for this year. For more information, go to www.tlcfamilyrc.org.

Mr. Contois said in 2019 he attended Pride events and that these folks have a right to live without interference. He endorses this proclamation.

Mayor Lovett said the Rotary Clubs in the region partnered with Common Man to hand out face masks this last weekend. In Claremont, they handed out over 2,200 face masks. All the money collected will go back to the community for public health issues. The Rotary is grateful to Common Man for helping to get this done.

Mayor Lovett talked about the net metering letter signed by mayors to extend the cap from 1 MW to 5 MW. The legislature meets on this tomorrow.

Mr. O'Hearne noted that the House Representatives will meet at the UNH arena in Durham to comply with social distancing. This will be the first time since the Civil War that the House has not met at the State House.

Mayor Lovett talked about pandemic unemployment assistance for people in the community and that these new benefits are being launched by the Department of Employment Security on June 11th.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. Morris said he has received word that the City will receive \$15,000 from the CARES Act for two airport projects.

Fire Chief Bryan Burr said every 24 seconds a fire department in the US responds to a fire. A cooking fire is the most common cause of residential fires. He gave an update of the most recent fires that occurred in Claremont in April and May: not connected; not suspicious/arson; no indication of a trend in the City, it is a spike; two were fatal. Practice good fire prevention; don't

leave the cooking area, don't leave smoking materials around a child; maintain smoke alarms; hire a professional electrician. 2020 Fire Prevention Theme is Serve Up Fire Safety in the Kitchen. Fire Prevention Week is October 4-10.

Mr. Morris talked about Black Lives Matter, the protests, and the unfortunate murder of George Floyd saying the City needs to move forward with this.

Police Chief Mark Chase said that the Claremont Police Department works hard to maintain public confidence, by maintaining transparency and accountability. Their main focus is to make the community safe. He condemned the actions of the former Minneapolis, Minnesota, police officer and further condemns the inaction of the other former officers at the scene that failed to intervene in the death of George Floyd. He said the Claremont Police Department works to keep its policies up to date. There are instances when police officers must use force and they are trained for that. It is done with best practices in mind. The Use of Force Policy is updated frequently, and it is monitored within the agency. Body and cruiser cams have been used since April 2019. All members are required to wear a body camera when working with the public.

Mr. Morris continued on with his report.

- Parks and Recreation Department is taking registrations for outside fitness classes. Classes are \$3 each for members and nonmembers.
- Parks and Recreation is moving forward with skills & drills for kids.
- The Library will be opened on Monday.
- The City has received notice that the CDBG (Community Development Block Grant) grant for Sugar River Co-op was approved by Governor and Council. This is for a study on the sewer and water line.
- The City has decided not to have a fireworks program on July 4th. Lebanon decided not to have theirs which would mean Claremont would be the only community within a hundred miles to have a show and the City would not be able to handle the crowd. We are looking at possible future dates. We are working with Magee Toyota, who are okay with delaying the show or holding the money until next year.
- In 2019, the Police Department put in for COPS (Community Oriented Policing Services) grant for one full-time officer, to be covered 75% for three years. The City will cover 25% and it is expected the officer will be maintained for 1 year afterward. The Police Department will use this officer for traffic. This will be brought forward at a later time.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Mr. O'Hearne, for discussion, to direct the City Manager to have a fireworks program as regularly scheduled.

Mr. Stone said that everything is opening back up and the fireworks is very important to the citizens of Claremont. If you can have a protest [protest was recently held in Broad Street Park], then you can have a fireworks display. Take safety precautions, if necessary.

There was a discussion for, and against, having the fireworks display.

Mr. Morris said the City can plan for precautions, but cannot limit the number of people that would come into the City. He suspects that people would come in from Massachusetts [which is

having a high rate of coronavirus infections] and he thinks that would be irresponsible. Also, having this in the park would be against state guidance.

People were typing in comments in the Chat section and Mayor Lovett read Mr. Mooshian's comment that this would be a public health risk, and that the City Manager should consult with the hospital and/or CDC for their recommendations.

Mayor Lovett said she was on a White House conference call and Dr. Birx, said that 60-70% of people who are testing positive are asymptomatic. People need to continue social distancing, wearing masks, and hand washing.

Mr. Koloski said in addition to the chat comments, people who are calling in should be asked if they have any comments. Mayor Lovett asked if anyone on the phone wished to speak. No one did.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - no

Kier - no

Sweetser - no

Damren - no

Matteau - no

Koloski - no

Contois - yes

Stone - no

Lovett - no

Motion failed 1-8.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Personnel Advisory Board

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Matteau to appoint Claire Lessard to seat 3 of the Personnel Advisory Board.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Rebecca MacKenzie, Ward 2, said Mayor Lovett had asked what happened to the Racial Healing Group. Because of diminished participation, it was not feasible to continue. However, Ms. MacKenzie encouraged folks who have an interest in participating in education programs to build resilience and solidarity, to come forward and help with those issues.

Sam Killay, Ward 3, said he wanted to lodge a protest against Councilor Stone because of comments he posted on his Facebook page after the May 27 Council meeting regarding his opposition to making the wearing of face masks mandatory. He said the post was inaccurate, because at the meeting it was stated that mask wearing was not a mandate, just a recommendation.

Mr. Stone made a point of order that this is an agenda item.

Mr. Killay said this is a complaint about a Councilor's behavior and his conscious choice to misrepresent the facts.

Matt Mooshian, Ward 2, expressed gratitude for the Mayor, Councilors and City Manager attending the vigil. Questions: What are you doing as community leaders to show solidarity in the fight for black lives? What are you planning to do in support of our non-white community members? What are you doing to name and call out white supremacy and police violence?

Nicholas Koloski, Ward 3, spoke as a citizen, saying that since his family restaurant has not been able to operate since mid-March, they still have bills. So, they have been working with other community members, and they are restocking their coolers, sending out fresh produce and dairy, etc. every Thursday. If anyone from the community can benefit from that, his contact information can be found on social media (Facebook).

Fred Thompson, Ward 1, small business owner for 17 years, said he was concerned about the rising tax rate in Claremont, especially with everything that has been happening because of COVID-19.

Mayor Lovett said this will be discussed during the budget discussion.

OLD BUSINESS

COVID-19 Update

Mr. Morris said the numbers have been lower: 300 new cases statewide since Thursday, 5,178 total, 5 active cases now; 32 have been tested in Claremont between Friday and Sunday.

Resolution 2020-31 Encourage Wearing of Masks – Public Hearing

WHEREAS, the Governor of New Hampshire declared a state of emergency on March 13, 2020 due to the COVID-19 pandemic; and

WHEREAS, COVID-19 cases exist in each of the 10 counties in the state; and

WHEREAS, the Center for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) has stated that wearing a mask and maintaining social distancing is critical to slowing the transmission of this highly infectious virus; and

WHEREAS, preventing transmission is critical to public health and efforts to re-open the economy:

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby strongly encourages the public to wear masks in public places in accordance with CDC guidelines during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Mayor Lovett said regarding asymptomatic transmission, there was a strong push from Dr. Birx for people to get tested. She encouraged everyone in the community to get tested. It is tied to slowing down the virus and opening the economy.

Ms. Kier talked about her personal experience of quarantine due to contact with a positive individual and that she tested negative.

Mr. Contois said that he has been tested at the Claremont Middle School. He pointed out that between yesterday and today 15 more people are dead, bringing the number of deaths to 301 in the state.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2020-31 Encourage Wearing of Masks.

Ms. Kier read the resolution into the record.

Mr. Koloski supports wearing masks. There is some confusion that this resolution is making mask wearing mandatory. There is a need for more education.

Ms. Sweetser agreed with Mr. Koloski there needs to be more education.

Ms. Matteau said it is the Councilors' jobs to encourage mask wearing to cut down on transmission of the virus. This resolution is a recommendation. Wearing a mask helps protect people around you.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Ms. Sweetser to move the question.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - no

Sweetser - yes

Damren - no

Matteau - no

Koloski - no

Contois - no
Stone - yes
Lovett - no
Motion failed 3-6.

Mr. Damren said this resolution uses the words “strongly encourages.” This is not a mandate.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing.

Rebecca MacKenzie, Ward 2, appreciates the resolution, however, she would appreciate having an ordinance requiring people to wear masks while in public. She talked about the vigil on Monday and said that anyone attending large gatherings should be tested five days later.

Fred Thompson, Ward 1, asked if the resolution states no mask, no service. Mayor Lovett said no. It’s the recommendation from the Governor’s office that business owners have control over their environment. The public is strongly encouraged to wear face masks.

Mayor Lovett closed the public hearing.

Roll call vote:
O’Hearne - yes
Kier - yes
Sweetser - no
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - no
Contois - yes
Stone - no
Lovett - yes
Motion carried 6-3.

Logistics for Non-Public Sessions During State of Emergency

Mayor Lovett said the Governor has confirmed that after June 15, the number who can be physically present in a meeting will be increased.

Mr. Morris said the Council can meet at the CSB Community Center (CSBCC) to be able to maintain social distancing. He recommends everyone wear masks.

Mr. Stone said that he was okay with holding a non-public session at the CSBCC with social distancing and wearing masks.

Ms. Kier said she is not 100% comfortable with all Councilors being together. She works at a clinic and she could possibly be infected, but not know it.

Mr. Koloski was fine with the social distancing and wearing masks.

Ms. Matteau was not comfortable, yet and asked if she could meet over the phone.

Mr. Damren didn't see any problem meeting over the phone or meeting at the CSBCC.

Mayor Lovett asked Mr. O'Hearne if he still wanted the non-public session. Mr. O'Hearne said he does, but this is a Council of nine. He commented that tomorrow, he will meet with, potentially, 400 Representatives in Durham, NH, but locally we can't get 9 people together.

After some more discussion, the majority of the Councilors agreed that a meeting could be held at the CSBCC and those who were not comfortable with that could call in.

Mr. Stone recommended June 17th.

Comcast Agreement

Mr. Morris said this agreement was presented to the Council before and the Council was not comfortable with the 10-year agreement. After discussion Comcast agreed to an 8-year agreement.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Matteau to take this off the table.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Matteau to authorize the City Manager or his designees to enter into a Cable Television Franchise Agreement between the City of Claremont and Comcast of Connecticut/Georgia/Massachusetts/New Hampshire/New York/North Carolina/Virginia/ Vermont, LLC for the term of eight (8) years, beginning June 10, 2020 and ending at midnight on June 9, 2028.

Mr. Koloski read the motion into the record.

Matt Skane, Comcast Representative, thanked the Council for its time to consider the renewal, and he thanked Mr. Morris and Mary Walter, Finance Director, for all the work they've done on this.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - no

Kier - no
Sweetser - no
Damren - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Contois - no
Stone - no
Lovett - yes
Motion failed 4-5.

Mayor Lovett asked if this “no” vote will affect Comcast’s current service.

Mr. Skane said it won’t adversely affect customers when it comes to the services provided. Finding out what the Councilor’s objections are would be helpful. They are making a significant investment when it comes to the line extensions.

Mayor Lovett said it would be appreciated for those who voted no, to provide feedback to the City Manager.

Ordinance 574 Amending Non-Union Employee Classification Plan – Third Reading – Public Hearing

The purpose of this proposed change is to replace the current Health Service Inspector position with that of the Deputy Building Inspector & Health Officer position. No grade or salary ranges will be impacted by this amendment as the new position will simply assume that of the former Health Service Inspector’s pay schedule (Grade 8 of the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule – Attachment C). The current maximum salary for a Grade 8 employee is \$56,829 and the minimum salary is \$37,362.60.

The amendment is intended to broaden interest in this position by expanding the scope of potential candidates for same. The Health Service Inspector position has been vacant for approximately 15 years and is somewhat limited in terms of its duties, the title and responsibilities for this new position are more in line with the needs of the City. With the change in title and description of duties, the hope is that more individuals will be enticed to apply for this position.

Enactment of this Ordinance will amend the City of Claremont Merit Plan accordingly and institute a full job description for the position of Deputy Building Inspector & Heath Officer. This change is requested by the City Manager.

Mr. Morris said the City has been trying to hire another inspector. This is to create a Deputy Building Inspector & Health Officer position so we can increase inspections, address blight and continue with the inspection program.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to suspend Council Rules to not read the entire ordinance.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - no

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Contois - yes

Stone - no

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 6-3.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to adopt Ordinance 574 Amending Non-Union Employee Classification Plan on third reading.

Mr. Damren read the Explanation of Proposed Action into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

Budget Discussion

Mayor Lovett said the public hearing is June 24. She suggested holding a special meeting on June 17th, at 6:30 p.m. for an in-depth budget discussion and that they could combine this with a non-public session.

The majority of the Council agreed to meet on June 17, 6 p.m. and to start the meeting with the non-public session.

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2020-28 Encumbrances – Public Hearing

BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after public hearing duly noticed, that it hereby adopts the following for the 2020 encumbrances: *(Majority vote required)*

Dept #	Department - General Description	Amount	Detailed Description
411	Policy/Executive	\$ 25,000	Encumber for Code Enforcement/Property Maintenance for FY 2021
416	Planning & Development	\$ 3,000	Encumber for Bidding and one time set up costs for new online GIS system
416	Planning & Development	\$ 15,000	Consult and design new marketing messaging and material suitable for online advertising
421	Police	\$ 40,000	Purchase of Lockers and upgrades to existing shower
421	Police	\$ 8,000	Continued improvements in the booking room to include equipment and safety measures.
421	Police	\$ 15,000	Purchase of snowmobile for CPD to access radio tower, rail trail patrol and/or other snow related emergency calls.
421	Police	\$ 111,000	To cover the City's share of the COPS grant over the three-year period so that no additional funds would be needed over the next three budget cycles to cover this officer if these funds are approved.
421	Police - Re-encumber from FY18, FY19 and FY20- recruiting bonus	\$ 30,000	Re-Encumber Recruiting Bonus: Spent \$17,200 in FY 18 for 3 hires and none in FY19 or FY20. Would like to continue carrying over funds in hopes of attracting qualified candidates.
471	Cemetery	\$ 3,000	Keep towards cost of mower replacement every 3 years.
481	Parks & Recreation	\$ 2,000	Awarded RTP trail grant - towards our share
TIFD	P&D/Downtown TIFD	\$ 25,000	Engineering services and demolition costs anticipated for the old Sullivan tower/wheelhouse

	Total Request to Encumber into FY 2020	\$ 277,000	To use the General Fund monies (\$252,000) and TIFD monies (\$25,000) already raised on the tax rate for projects, services or equipment that were not able to be completed in the current Fiscal year.
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There was a brief discussion for clarity.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2020-28 Encumbrances.

Mr. Koloski read the resolution into the record.

Mr. Damren said the number at the bottom should be FY2021.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing.

Fred Thompson, Ward 1, asked for, and received, clarification.

Mayor Lovett closed the public hearing.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - no

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - no

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 7-2.

Mayor Lovett said based on these encumbrances she'll have questions for the proposed budget.

Twin State Properties Tax Deed

Mr. Morris said at the July 24, 2019, Council meeting, Council put these properties on the Refuse Tax Deed list in order to lien the properties for the RSA 155b action to be taken on the 139 Main Street property. There are multiple liens on these properties. He talked with an attorney and found that municipal tax liens would go to the front of the list, however an RSA 155b lien would go to end of the list and does not have priority. Some properties were purchased during previous tax deed processes. It is safe to assume they would not sell for enough money to cover the RSA 155b. He recommended removing these properties from the Refuse Tax Deed list

and add them to the Tax Deed list. These will go through the process and may take time to process. Before they are sold, reverter clauses will be placed on these properties.

There was a discussion including needing more information about the properties at 342 East Green Mountain Road and 36 Sugar River Drive.

There was concern whether or not the City Clerk had to come before the Council to request taking these properties off the Refuse Tax Deed list.

A motion was made by Mr. Stone and seconded by Mr. Koloski to table this to July 22.

Mr. Morris said these will not make the September sale, so they will have to wait until next spring.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

City Hall Roof Repair (to come from Unanticipated Revenue)

Mr. Morris said the Council approved accepting \$341,154 in state aid received for the Arrowhead project and the Claremont Opera House (COH) HVAC project when we did not know the exact cost of the HVAC project. At that time, he told the Council if it would accept expending the entire amount, he would come back with the projects as we were going through them. The Arrowhead project was to come in at \$95,600. The latest total we have is a little higher than that. COH HVAC was \$175,136 and we are expecting that to be completed in August. It was recommended the roof be put on after the COH HVAC. The atrium roof is the same PVC membrane roof as the one over the COH. The cost is \$56,250. Section H, skylight area over the lower atrium, is estimated to be over \$30,000 and there would not be enough money to do both. He asked the Council to authorize to repair the PVC roof over the atrium for \$56,250 which will save the City in mobilization costs. The plans, when submitted to the Governor, were to do drainage repair on the sidewalk in front of the Farwell Block and by the steps by the Police Station, and putting in some LED lights and insulation at the Visitors Center, but he believes it is better to get the roofing project done.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Matteau to authorize the City Manager or his designee(s) to use \$56,250 of remaining funds from Unanticipated Revenue to repair the roof over the atrium.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

River Front Park Concept Discussion

Mr. Morris said there have been some issues with the Sullivan Tower and the pump house next to it.

Ms. Merrill said this is the beginning of the Phase I study. The lot is between North and Spring Streets. Last year, we received a Phase I environmental grant from UVLSRPC and that work has been completed. As part of that work, they did some planning for us on park concepts. The pump house is dangerous. There are holes in the building wall and holes in the floor. There are three recommendations on the Phase I of the study: 1) Clear the site of vegetation for better observation of the buildings & area; 2) Perform a Phase II ESA; and 3) Conduct a Hazardous Building Materials Survey. There is a Phase II study that will begin using the same grant. That will be a more detailed look at the soil. There may be an underground storage tank. The Phase II study report is expected back in August. Previously, people asked about housing in that area which would be difficult because of the overhead powerlines.

Next Steps:

- Historic District Commission
- Demolition estimates & funding
- City Council – Use & funding
- RFP for demolition
- Phase 2, environmental report
- Parks & Rec Commission
- Survey and detailed layout

Mr. Morris talked with an engineer about part of the pump house being in the river, and that it is grandfathered. They talked about removing the building and leaving some of the footing structure in order to create an overlook. They also talked about keeping some of the historic bricks from the smokestack for some of the other structures.

There was a discussion about having a public/private partnership on the project.

Mr. Morris said the City is looking into ways to secure the path leading to those buildings to try to keep people away from them.

Discussion of Audit Letter

Mr. Stone acknowledged that the audit letter was filled out by the Assistant Mayor. He asked why the entire Council was not sent the letter in advance in order give input.

Mayor Lovett said the auditors sent it to the Mayor or Assistant Mayor to fill out.

Mr. Damren said it is not an audit letter. It is an internal control letter. It was sent to the Mayor and to him. Council can direct the auditors to send it to every City Councilor.

Mr. Stone said in the future, he would like the letter to be sent to the entire Council.

Mr. Morris said in the future, the letter could be sent to each Councilor to be filled out, individually, not from the Council as a group, so if the auditors have questions, they can reach out to the individual Councilor, if needed.

Approval/Denial of Police Union Contract

Moved to June 24th meeting.

Lafayette Trail Marker

Mayor Lovett said in 1825 Marquis de Lafayette made a farewell tour in the United States. A nonprofit, headed by Julien Icher, has mapped out his farewell tour. Communities can place a marker where he stayed. The markers are paid for by the nonprofit. The City's responsibility will be to install and maintain the marker. She said it was discussed at the May 20 meeting of the Historic District Commission and they are enthusiastic about it. Mr. Icher is working with the Fiske Free Library and the Claremont Historical Society. This is to celebrate that the Marquis de Lafayette was here and that he was a big part of the history of the founding of this country. The marker will read: Lafayette's Tour. On June 27, 1825, Lafayette was received in Claremont at Stevens Hotel. He left the next morning for Windsor, Vermont.

A motion was made by Ms. Matteau and seconded by Mr. Damren to accept the Lafayette Trail Marker.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 9-0.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Mr. Damren said the Finance Committee met last Wednesday, and discussed a recommendation made by the Claremont Planning Board to give thought to establishing a capital reserve. He will forward the Committee's recommendation to the City Manager's office to be forwarded to the Council prior to the next meeting. The Finance Committee will meet next Wednesday.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Mayor Lovett said Ms. Kier had requested a resolution for condemning police brutality and supporting racial justice. Ms. Kier said she would hope this would not need much conversation. Ms. Kier said this is timely. Mayor Lovett said it would go on the June 24th agenda, if possible, but no later than July 8th. There was consensus that Ms. Kier should work with City staff to draft the resolution.

Mr. Koloski asked for an update on cameras in the City to see if they are operable because there is graffiti in the Parking Garage. He asked about a camera down toward the Santagate Bridge; it has graffiti all over it.

Regarding the bowstring bridge adjoining the Common Man, Mr. Koloski asked if there is a marker identifying it, and if so, to clear the brush so that it could be seen.

Mr. Morris said the camera in the Parking Garage is working. The Police have identified the people responsible for the graffiti and they are working that case. He doesn't know about the Santagate Bridge.

Ms. Kier wants an update on the Compensation Study. Mr. Morris will try to add that to his City Manager's Report.

Ms. Kier would like the Council to consider a proposal of censure for Mr. Stone for knowingly dispersing incorrect information on something as important as a resolution on public safety and health. She reminded everyone that a censure is a statement of disapproval, and she believes this is something to disapprove of. She would like to discuss in an upcoming meeting a potential censure.

Mr. Stone said he would like to add to an agenda Ms. Kier's possible violation of the City's Code of Conduct in regard to an employment matter. Mayor Lovett said that is scheduled for the June 24 meeting. Mr. Stone confirmed that this is a Councilor issue, not an employee issue.

Mr. Koloski said since someone showed up in Council Chambers, he would like to discuss, maybe at the 24th meeting when we will get back to normal meetings, or at least allowing public members to join Councilors in Council Chambers, while wearing masks.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 10:12 p.m., a motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. O'Hearne to adjourn.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Kier - no

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-1.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council